

Katherine Irons

kirons323@gmail.com / 617-548-6196
<https://www.linkedin.com/in/katherine-m-irons/>
<https://katherineandherreptiles.com/>
Southborough, MA 01745

Professional Summary

Detail-oriented software engineer with experience in various industries. Highly experienced in modernizing legacy systems. Team player who values collaboration with other engineers as well as stakeholders, ensuring functional requirements are met above and beyond. Proven track record in delivering robust, high-performance systems.

Professional Experience

DataAnnotation — *Remote*

AI Data Trainer | *February 2026 - present*

- Evaluated, ranked, and annotated AI model responses against detailed quality and accuracy criteria to support model training.
- Created and tested diverse prompts intended to identify model weaknesses and failure points, contributing to more robust AI behavior.
- Developed structured evaluation rubrics to assess response quality, relevance, accuracy, and adherence to prompt and safety requirements.
- Reviewed the work of other trainers, offering suggestions and improvements to help better teach the models and enhance training standards.

Atlassian — *Remote*

Senior Software Engineer | *June 2023 - June 2025*

- Spearheaded the team's observability efforts, strategically prioritizing tasks to align with capacity while addressing high-impact and high-risk areas in the application.
- Led the triage of an extensive backlog of Sentry-reported errors, categorizing issues by frequency and severity to guide efficient prioritization and resolution.
- Re-engineered classic ASP pages to ASP.NET, Visual Basic, and C#. Included rigorous unit testing to ensure equivalent functionality.
- Converted hardcoded HTML into modern, maintainable React components.
- Investigated and resolved customer support tickets, adding new JUnit and SpecFlow tests for ongoing coverage.
- Designed and implemented new REST APIs to improve performance and data retrieval flexibility for both internal and external users.

- Conducted performance testing on new and updated code to ensure improved performance for UI and APIs that satisfactorily met performance benchmarks.
- Developed and executed qTests for bug fixes and new features to maintain product stability and regression-free code.
- Participated in the on-call rotation to monitor production issues via Splunk and SignalFX dashboards, and addressed customer-reported incidents requiring immediate resolution.
- Served as a Release Manager to oversee and coordinate weekly Jira Align releases and out-of-cycle hotfix releases.
- Mentored a new graduate engineer.

Center for Internet Security (CIS) — *Remote*

Senior Software Engineer | *August 2021 - May 2023*

- Modernized a highly fragmented legacy codebase which had been rewritten many times over to improve its performance, extensibility, and maintainability.
- Improved the CI/CD infrastructure for two products by architecting build stages and OS-specific bundles on AWS CodePipeline.
- Automated package signing and hash generation with AWS Lambda for customer verification.
- Maintained dependency security by addressing vulnerabilities flagged by Maven.
- Collaborated closely with support to resolve critical issues.
- Met with customers as necessary and increased ease of application use based on feedback.

PTC — *Boston, MA / Remote*

Software Engineer | *July 2019 - August 2021*

- Fixed customer-reported issues in backend legacy Java code.
- Developed a JavaScript-based tool to replicate complex relational database content.
- Identified and remediated security vulnerabilities using static code analysis tools.
- Mentored summer interns for two consecutive years and supported their onboarding and training.

Optum — *Boston, MA*

Software Developer | *June 2017 - June 2019*

- Participated in innovation projects, including development of an AR mobile minigame to help customers understand healthcare coverage.

Education

Boston University

Master of Science: Computer Information Systems - May 2022

Concentration in IT Project Management

Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute (RPI)

Bachelor of Science: Computer Science, Mathematics - May 2017

Magna Cum Laude

Certifications

GIAC Security Essentials Certification (GSEC) - May 2023

Technical Skills

Languages & Frameworks:

Java, C#, Groovy, Grails, ASP.NET, Visual Basic, Python, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, React, C++

Testing & QA Tools:

JUnit, Cucumber, SpecFlow, qTest, Selenium, Sitespeed.io, JMeter

Databases:

MySQL, Microsoft SQL Server, MariaDB, PostgreSQL

Cloud & DevOps:

AWS CodePipeline, AWS Lambda, AWS EC2, AWS CloudFormation

Developer Tools:

SonarQube, Splunk, SignalFX, Sentry, Jira, Confluence, Bitbucket, Git, GitHub, IntelliJ, Visual Studio, Visual Studio Code, Jenkins, Octopus

Methodologies:

Agile (Scrum, Kanban), Waterfall, CI/CD, TDD